

GEDION TESHOME DISASSA

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Addis Ababa, Ethiopia



EDUCATION

BSc., Software Engineering

09/2018 - 07/2022

Addis Ababa Science and Technology University, AASTU

Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

- *Relevant courses:* Data Structures & Algorithms, Statistics, Calculus, Discrete Math, Computer Architecture, Systems Programming, OOP
- Graduation Capstone Project **ranked #1** from the Department of Software Engineering in the class of 2022.
- CGPA: 3.51/4.0

Deep Learning and Computational Neuroscience, Summer School

07/2024 – 07/2024

Neuromatch Academy, Interactive Track and Course Project

Remote

- Completed a comprehensive 3 weeks (128 hours) program focused on Deep Learning, enhancing skills in neural networks, cutting-edge machine learning techniques, and practical applications in the field.
- Verified certificate: [Certificate Verification](#)

Training, Coding Academy

02/2022 - 11/2022

Africa to Silicon Valley, A2SV

Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

- A2SV upskills students with a 360° software engineering program that focuses on improving problem-solving, system designing, effective speaking, and personal development. A2SV trains high-potential African students and connects them with top Silicon Valley companies.
- Solved over 500 problems on different problem-solving contest platforms such as LeetCode, Codeforces, and HackerRank

MLH Fellowship, Fellow

07/2021 – 08/2021

Major League Hacking, MLH

Remote

an intensive software engineering experience, during which fellows build out portfolio projects, experiment with new technologies, and collaborate in small groups(pods) during a short, impactful sprint.

Skills-lab Training, Data Science

06/2020 - 01/2021

Microsoft 4Afrika & Gebeya Inc.

Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

Coursework included: Data Modelling, Model Operationalization, Azure ML Studio, Statistics for Machine Learning, Advanced Python

- Scholarship winner to pursue rigorous Data Science training with hands-on skills-lab projects using Microsoft technologies.
- Recognized as a Top talent ranking 1st in the data science track; recruited as a *mentor* and technical *trainer* for next cohorts.

Professional Degree, Web Backend Engineering

04/2019 - 11/2019

Gebeya Inc.

Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

- Youngest graduate in Web Backend (API) Engineering track with a 98% score across 9 courses and 12+ evaluations.
- Developed and presented pitch decks for VC firms and angel investors, including Jack Dorsey of Twitter who requested demo of our MVP.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Data Science / Natural Language Processing Analyst

07/2023 - Present

United Nations Development Program, HQ/BPPS, Data, AI, and Innovation Hub (04/2025 – present)

New York, United States

- Taken on a leadership role as an AI developer and product manager for several data science, AI, and Geo-spatial related projects
- Responsible for 10+ products across different teams and 8+ country offices and regional bureaus.
- Host capacity building and training sessions for internal colleagues as well as government bodies on Data, AI, Policy and different governance frameworks.
- Design, develop, and shipped 12+ requests that has garnered a cumulative active usage of 90k+ active daily sessions.

United Nations Development Program, HQ/BPPS, SDGi Integration, Data Science (07/2023 – 04/2025)

New York, United States

- Played a pivotal role in the development and deployment of the SDG Integration Artificial Intelligence as a Service (SDGi AIaaS) within UNDP's cloud tenant utilized daily with 3000+ MAU.
- Architected and managed the multi-tiered infrastructure comprising cloud services, foundational APIs, AI service applications, and custom support layers, enabling the organization to harness AI capabilities effectively for policy and decision making.
- Spearheaded the development of production-grade AI solutions, including machine translation, document processing, conversational agents (chatbots), and information analysis, catering to program and policy development.
- Wrote multiple high-volume (terabytes) scrapers that run at scale to source data for model training and benchmarking against other models.
- Co-authored a SOTA GNN-based long-text classification model for the UN SDGs submitted to NLP for Social Good, 24.

Research Intern, ML and Computational Neuroscience

07/2023 – 09/2023

Max Planck Institute for Biological Cybernetics, Computational Neuroscience

Tübingen, Germany

- Worked on a cross-disciplinary research involving computational neuroscientist, clinical doctor, psychologist, and ML researcher under the supervision of Prof. Peter Dayan (MPI), Prof. Tobias Hauser (MUT), Dr. Leon Schulz, Ph.D., and Dr. Tricia Seow (UCL)
- Scraped large dataset of OCD forums and pre-processed different shapes of data format.
- Run state-of-the-art topic modeling using natural language to understand the diverse shape of OCD symptoms using Topic modeling.
- Standardized data and trained a classifier to verify the result of topic representation and discriminating control and patient group using generated topic.
- In addition to the technical aspect, completed soft skill trainings on abstract writing, presentation skills, scientific thinking, research workflow etc.

Software Engineer, Backend Team Lead

08/2022 - Present

Eskalate LLC

Menlo Park, California, United States

- Lead a team of 10 people that work on architecting, developing, testing, and shipping APIs for projects that run at scale.
- Designed a healthcare app that operates effectively in various network conditions, achieving over 95% transactional consistency, while ensuring compliance with HIPAA regulations through robust security and privacy measures.
- Won a reward of 8,000 USD by launching an MVP that beat four other projects by speeding up the health diagnosis pipeline by 300%.

Admissions Specialist

10/2021 - Present

Major League Hacking,

New York, United States (remote)

- Interviewed and assessed 1000+ applicants for a software engineering fellowship for behavioral and technical interviews for partner companies like Google, Solana Labs, and Meta.
- Cut down application processing speed by 4x by working through past applicant data metrics valued by our partners.
- Completed application review, code sample review, and application-process engineering with a globally distributed team of admission specialists.

Senior Full Stack Web Application Developer | Data Science and Python Technical Trainer

03/2021 – 04/2022

Gebeya Inc.

Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

- Worked on international projects on a contract basis to develop part and/or complete product features that improved user retention by an average of 29%.
- Mentored and gave technical training for 150+ talents on Python programming language, Data Structure and algorithms, and introductory Data Science topics.

Research Intern and AI Product Developer, Analytics Directorate

02/2021 – 11/2021

Technology and Innovation Institute, Ethiopia

Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

- In partnership with Microsoft, I was part of a team to support local government organizations to develop/integrate AI solutions into existing projects by developing new methodologies using cutting-edge academic papers.
- Developed an End-to-End Synthetic Voice Production Artificial Intelligence Natural Language Processing system to implement a Core synthesis service for a TTS system used on various products in 3 local languages.
- Consulted on 2 data sourcing and cleaning projects, and drafted AI project guidelines for the institute.

Community Partnership Specialist

03/2021 – 09/2021

Global AI Hub

Zurich, Switzerland (remote)

- Built positive relationships with community partners involved in technology and AI to establish partnerships with Global AI Hub.
- Sourced new leads, established connections, and pitched the partnership goals. Finally, close deals and monitor connections and liaison between new partners to achieve mutual benefit.

Lead Software Engineer Intern | CS Outreach | Course Developer

08/2020 – 02/2020

Def Hacks

Seattle, United States (remote)

- Re-architected the Def Hacks Learn platform boilerplate codebase to use UpToDate tooling and follow DRY principles.
- Automated the workload in the exchange of content between the development team and production team by writing a 65-75% reusable ETL script to upload batch JSON course data to the Fire-store database and a CDN.
- Implemented a strategic outreach plan to recruit underrepresented students in CS, resulting in approximately 60% more signups than the prior year in the EMEA region and sub-Saharan African countries.
- Created a detailed guideline and design guide for the content production team and the course development team.

LEADERSHIP & VOLUNTEERING

AMLD-Africa

- A volunteer reviewer to the poster submissions and workshop submissions for AMLD-Africa 2024

GitHub, Campus Expert

- Went through rigorous technical and professional training to build a strong technical community– public speaking, technical writing, community leadership, and software development to help the 600+ campus community.
- Organized workshops and gave mentorship to 100+ under-represented students in CS and technology.
- First-ever student to get the title of Campus Expert from GitHub in East Africa.

Teaching Assistant/Mentor, A2SV

- Coached 4 community members who wanted to join A2SV by hosting weekly lectures and how-to-approach sessions every weekend for 3 months.

MAJOR LEAGUE HACKING, Workshop Lead, and Organizer

- Developed and facilitated 'Hacktoberfest season' theme workshops and training for mid-school, high school, and college youth that resulted in 80+ attendants from 4 continents and was *the first-ever event of its kind in East Africa*.
- Formed a guild with 60+ students to learn bleeding-edge technologies and to build meaningful products with them.

Microsoft Learn, Microsoft Learn Student Ambassador & Google Student Developer Club, Core Team Member

- Selected as an ambassador based on my performance in advocating for technology and using Microsoft products to empower the developer community.
- Hosted workshops, training, and hackathons to teach Microsoft/Google technologies across a range of topics, specifically focused on Artificial intelligence and Machine Learning (Azure Cognitive Services) on healthcare and education leagues for a university with 2000+ residents and passionate learners.

AWARDS, SCHOLARSHIPS, AND HONORABLE MENTIONS

- MLH Top 50 Award, 2022 (from 300,000 community members)
- Tech Trend Africa, Top 10 African Influential Techie List
- Def Hacks, Recognition Post.
- Gebeya Hackathon – Ethio-Hacks IV, Smart apps - Second place winner - Full scholarship
- Gebeya Hackathon – Ethio-Hacks VI, IoT for the fifth industrial revolution - Second place winner
- MLH, Same Home Different Hacks 2020, *First Prize Winner (Global hackathon with 40+ teams)*
- African Leadership Academy, Full Scholarship (6% acceptance rate)
- National Merit Scholar Award, University of Minnesota
- Excellence of Academic Accomplishments, Certificate of Achievement, Exemplary Leadership Award - Dandii Boru School
- Qine-Qapeq, Science and Technology *Research Competition*, 2017: 2nd place prize winner
- Yale University – Yale Young African Scholar (YYAS) Ambassador and Alumna (Zimbabwe) (5% acceptance rate)

CERTIFICATIONS

- DP-100 - Microsoft Certified: Azure Data Scientist Associate (*January 2021*)
- Google Africa Developer Training Program, Associate Cloud Engineer (*February 2021*)
- AZ-900 - Microsoft Certified Professional: Azure fundamentals (*October 2020*)
- NVIDIA Deep Learning Institute - Certificate of Competency: Fundamentals of Deep Learning for Computer Vision (*December 2020*)
- National Information Technology Qualification Certificate (*February 2020*)
- Professional Web Back-End Application Engineer (*November 2019*)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Adobe XD, Illustrator	Python	Azure/Azure-ML	Node.js	Arduino	Advanced Office Pack
HTML/CSS	Pandas, NumPy	Docker/Kubernetes	Express	C/C++	Burp Suite
JavaScript	Scikit-Learn, TensorFlow	GCP, Firebase	MongoDB	Java/JavaFX	Power BI
React/Redux/D3.js	Jupyter Notebook	Git/GitHub	Postman	MySQL/Postgres	PyTorch

LANGUAGES

- Amharic – Native/Bilingual Proficiency
- English – Native/Bilingual Proficiency (TOEFL iBT 2017 - 109/120)
- German – B1